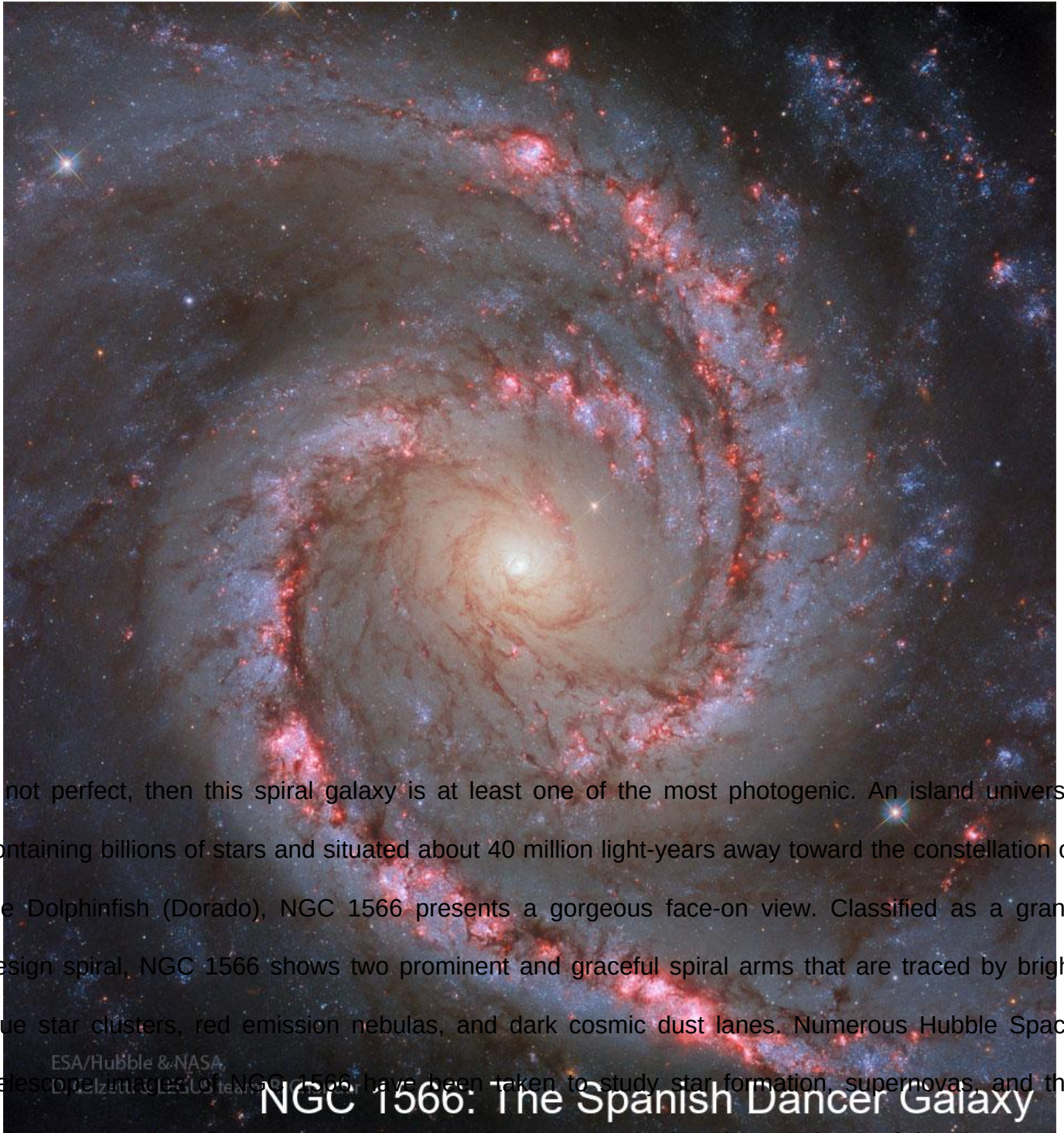


NGC 1566: The Spanish Dancer Galaxy



If not perfect, then this spiral galaxy is at least one of the most photogenic. An island universe containing billions of stars and situated about 40 million light-years away toward the constellation of the Dolphin (Dorado), NGC 1566 presents a gorgeous face-on view. Classified as a grand design spiral, NGC 1566 shows two prominent and graceful spiral arms that are traced by bright blue star clusters, red emission nebulae, and dark cosmic dust lanes. Numerous Hubble Space

Telescope images of NGC 1566 have been taken to study star formation, supernovas, and the

spiral's unusually active center. NGC 1566's flaring center makes the spiral one of the closest and brightest Seyfert galaxies, likely housing a central supermassive black hole wreaking havoc on surrounding stars and gas. Sky Surprise: What picture did APOD feature on your birthday? (after 1995)

